1. About this dashboard & the data

This dashboard explores the global medical doctor workforce using data from the WHO National Health Workforce Accounts (NHWA) data portal, December 2025 update (apps.who.int/nhwaportal). It covers 194 countries and 5 indicators: total doctors, doctors per 10,000 people, generalists, specialists and doctors not further defined. Data runs from 1971 to 2024, but coverage is thin in the early years.

2. How I prepared the data

- Loaded one flat WHO table of 14,814 rows and 34 columns into Power BI.
- In Power Query, removed 25 empty, constant or duplicate columns and kept 9.
- Rebuilt it as a **star schema**: one fact table (country, indicator, year, value) and three dimensions (country with WHO region, indicator, year).
- Added indicator groupings (rate vs. count, and doctor category).
- Wrote DAX measures. The “latest” measures use each country’s most recent reported year, so totals are never added across years.

3. Key insights

- **The workforce is concentrated.** China, India, the USA, Russia and Brazil hold about 51% of the 14.8M doctors. China alone holds about 27%.
- **Africa has a very small share.** It holds about 2.6% of doctors, and its average rate is about 3.6 per 10,000, compared with about 39.5 in Europe, roughly 11 times higher.
- **Many countries have low density.** 70 of 194 countries (36%) have fewer than 10 doctors per 10,000 people. The median is about 18.
- **Rates are generally rising.** For example, Africa’s average rose from about 1.3 (1990) to 3.5 (2023), and the Eastern Mediterranean from 6.7 to 18.6. Gaps between regions remain large.
- **Specialist share varies.** Among countries that report both categories, specialists make up about 77% of generalist-plus-specialist doctors in Europe, but only about 24% in Africa (a smaller sample).

4. How to read this dashboard

- **Cards:** headline figures for the latest year of each country. They change when you use the slicers or click a chart.
- **Slicers:** filter by WHO region or country.
- **Map:** darker = more doctors per 10,000 people.
- **Region bars:** total doctors by WHO region. Click a bar to filter the whole page, and click again to clear it.
- **Trend lines:** average doctors per 10,000 over time, 1990–2023, one line per region.
- **Top 10:** countries with the highest density. Very small countries such as Monaco and Andorra can rank high because of their small populations.

5. Limitations

- “Latest year” varies by country (2020–2024), so the figures are not a snapshot of one year.
- Fewer countries reported in 2024 (72) than in 2023 (117), so trends stop at 2023.
- Trend lines average the reporting countries, and the mix of countries changes over time.
- Doctors per 10,000 can’t be summed across countries, so regional values are simple averages and not population-weighted.

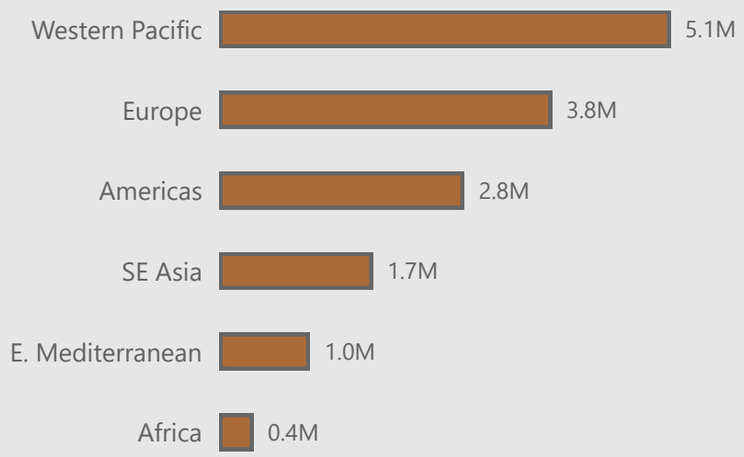
Region: All

Country: All

Global Medical Doctor Workforce (WHO data)

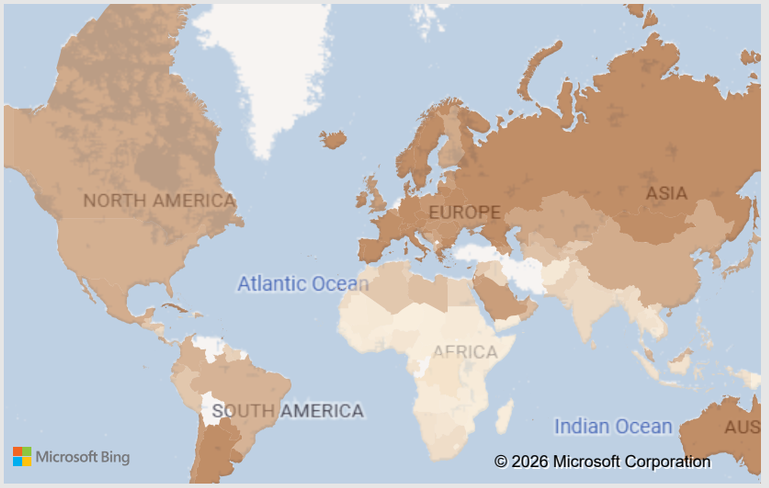
Doctors (Latest)	Doctors per 10,000 (Latest)	Countries Reporting	Specialist Share (Latest)
14.78M	20.88	194	65.08%

Doctors by WHO region (latest year)

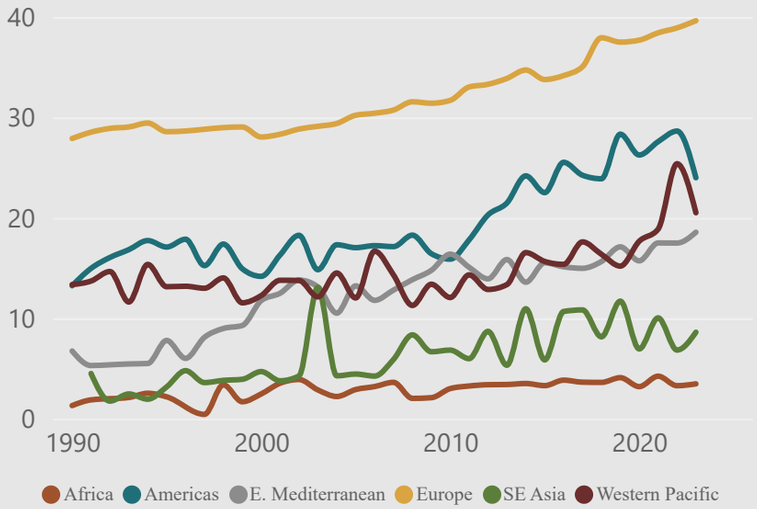


Doctors per 10,000 people, by country (latest year)

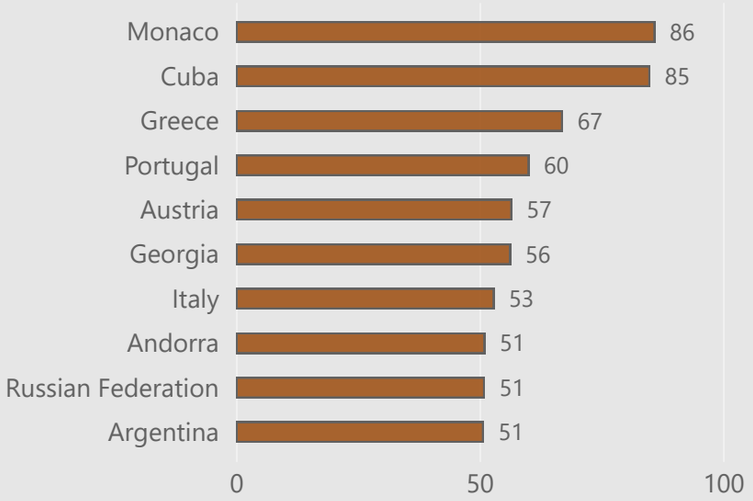
Darker = more doctors per 10,000



Doctors per 10,000 over time, by WHO region



Top 10 countries by doctors per 10,000



Source: WHO National Health Workforce Accounts. Latest year varies by country (2020–2024). Trend lines show averages of reporting countries, and coverage changes over time. Very small countries (e.g. Monaco, Andorra) can have unusually high rates.